

WI-FI ADSL ROUTERS

Amongst the wireless routers we received, just two were ADSL-ready: the Netgear DG834G and the ASUS WL-600G were the only two routers with ADSL modems inbuilt. Such routers are your first choice if your Internet Service Provider (ISP) provides you with a telephone line based broadband connection. Most telecom-based companies such as MTNL and Airtel will provide you with ADSL connectivity (RJ11-based). When getting such a connection, you are generally given the option of either purchasing your own modem or buying one from the ISP.

Now if you have a laptop or any wireless devices that you might want to share this Internet connection with, it's probably your best bet to invest in a Wi-Fi ADSL router. As you'll see from our tests, Wi-Fi ADSL routers offer extra features without compromising on performance. To top it off, they're not as expensive as you'd perceived them to be!

ASUS WL-600G

Features, performance, and looks collide...

The stunning WL-600G would grace any workspace it occupies, meriting at least a second glance! Build quality's excellent, and this was the only router with a convenient power on/off switch.

The WL-600G is a feature-rich offering, with two USB ports, and the ability to set up a print server. Its firmware interface has a few more settings available for tweaking, as compared to the other ASUS devices we tested.

The scores this one brought up weren't the



highest we got, but what blew us away were the signal strength figures, especially in Zones 2 and 3.

At 54 per cent in Zone 2, it's a whopping 8 per cent stronger than its closest rival, the Senao ECB3220.

Even in Zone 3, the WL-600G hammers everything around with a signal strength of 49 per cent!

This one has a lot of features, but the high price tag of Rs 8,500 will not please everyone.

Netgear DG834G

Sleek and fast

The pearl-white coloured Netgear DG834G is a sleek beauty. The activity indicators are also well-done, and clearly legible even under well-lit conditions.

We set this one up in a jiffy, thanks to the great firmware interface. Netgear also helpfully provides very detailed help for each option, and each item is very well explained. In fact, the help is so detailed, you could use it as a ready reference for what each option means.

The DG834G breezed through most of our



tests, clocking the fastest time in our Zone 2 multiple file transfer, averaging a blazing 1.09 MBps. This router will be very suitable for a SoHo user who wants to transfer a lot of data wirelessly. It's equally at ease browsing bandwidth-hogging Web pages.

At Rs 4,230, the DG834G keeps your wallet happy... very happy, considering the features and the fact that it's blazingly fast.

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We received seven such devices. The difference between these and their ADSL counterparts is they don't have ADSL modems inbuilt. They cannot therefore utilise an RJ11 WAN connection. Most routers will have an RJ45 interface for WAN connections.

ASUS WL-530G

Tiny but mighty!

The "small wonder" in this test, it's small enough to be stuffed inside your cargo trouser pockets, yet powerful enough to ensure a near-seamless unwired experience.

The activity LEDs are, surprisingly, mounted behind the device and on top. We'd have preferred them in front, or at least where they can be viewed easily even if the device is kept above the user's line of sight.

ASUS' software definitely isn't the best laid-out



that we tested, and neither is the main menu very intuitive.

Due to its tiny footprint, we'd recommend it to the hotspot browser on the move. Its speed of 1.29 MBps was unmatched in the Zone 1 test. This makes it suitable for setting up a home or SoHo wireless office where its potent data throughput capabilities will be put to good use. It excelled in the video streaming test as well, meaning you needn't sit in front of your PC's monitor if you own one of these.

At Rs 4,400, the WL-530G offers excellent value for money. If you're looking for the fastest Wi-Fi router out there, grab the WL-530G—it's our Best Buy Gold winner!